

He stood too close today.

Beril was sitting outside on the back balcony, sipping something too cold for the weather. I was upstairs, looking down through the stairwell window. He came out five minutes later – same coat, same stiff posture – and leaned against the wall, maybe three meters from her.

Not close enough to be noticed.
But close enough to hear her breath if he tried.

He never spoke.
She didn't see him at first. But I watched her body shift – shoulders tensed, left foot started tapping unconsciously, hand gripped her cup tighter.

That's the body remembering something.
Not reacting to the present – reacting to a memory.

Eventually she looked up and saw him.
He didn't move. He didn't even pretend to be distracted.
Just kept his head turned slightly toward her, as if she were a podcast he didn't want to miss.

She left a minute later.

He stayed.

I don't think he wanted a conversation.
I think he wanted the tension.
And I think he wanted her to know it.

Temporary label remains: R-3
Next step: Confirm identity. Review archived descriptions from previous files.
Something here feels... too familiar.

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